

0.0.1 Two Categories of Thoughts

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Savatthi in Jeta's Grove, Anathapindika's Park. At that place the Auspicious One addressed the bhikkhus: "Bhikkhus." "Bhante," those bhikkhus replied to the Auspicious One. The Auspicious One said this:

2. In the past, O bhikkhus, when I was just a bodhisatta, not yet fully awakened to perfect awakening, this occurred to me: "What if I were to dwell having repeatedly put my thoughts into two categories." So I, O bhikkhus, put into one category thoughts of sensual desire, thoughts of ill-will and thoughts of harming; and into the second category thoughts of renunciation, thoughts of non-ill-will and thoughts of non-harming.

3. Of me, O bhikkhus, dwelling thus ever vigilant, ardent and resolute, thoughts of sensual desire arose. I wisely understood: This thought of sensual desire has arisen in me. It leads to my own affliction, to the affliction of others and to the affliction of both. It impedes wisdom, is on the side of vexation, leads away from nibbana. While reviewing, O bhikkhus, that: "It leads to my own affliction," it subsided in me. While reviewing, O bhikkhus, that: "It leads to the affliction of others too," it subsided in me. While reviewing, O bhikkhus, that: "It leads to the affliction of both too," it subsided in me.

While reviewing, O bhikkhus, that: “It impedes wisdom, is on the side of vexation, leads away from nibbana too,” it subsided in me. Whatever thoughts of sensual desire that arose, O bhikkhus, I simply abandoned it, dispelled it, put an end to it.

4. Of me, O bhikkhus, dwelling thus ever vigilant, ardent and resolute, thoughts of ill-will arose. I wisely understood: This thought of ill-will has arisen in me. It leads to my own affliction, to the affliction of others and to the affliction of both. It impedes wisdom, is on the side of vexation, leads away from nibbana. While reviewing, O bhikkhus, that: “It leads to my own affliction,” it subsided in me. While reviewing, O bhikkhus, that: “It leads to the affliction of others too,” it subsided in me. While reviewing, O bhikkhus, that: “It leads to the affliction of both too,” it subsided in me. While reviewing, O bhikkhus, that: “It impedes wisdom, is on the side of vexation, leads away from nibbana too,” it subsided in me. Whatever thoughts of ill-will that arose, O bhikkhus, I simply abandoned it, dispelled it, put an end to it.

5. Of me, O bhikkhus, dwelling thus ever vigilant, ardent and resolute, thoughts of harming arose. I wisely understood: This thought of harming has arisen in me. It leads to my own affliction, to the affliction of others and to the affliction of both. It impedes wisdom, is on the side of vexation, a leads away from nibbana. While reviewing, O bhikkhus, that: “It leads to my own afflic-

tion,” it subsided in me. While reviewing, O bhikkhus, that: “It leads to the affliction of others too,” it subsided in me. While reviewing, O bhikkhus, that: “It leads to the affliction of both too,” it subsided in me. While reviewing, O bhikkhus, that: “It impedes wisdom, is on the side of vexation, leads away from nibbana too,” it subsided in me. Whatever thoughts of harming that arose, O bhikkhus, I simply abandoned it, dispelled it, put an end to it.

6. Whatever, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu thinks and ponders a lot about, just that becomes the inclination of the mind. If, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu thinks and ponders a lot about thoughts of sensual desire, then he has abandoned thoughts of renunciation to cultivate thoughts of sensual desire, and his mind inclines to thoughts of sensual desire accordingly. If, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu thinks and ponders a lot about thoughts of ill-will, then he has abandoned thoughts of non-ill-will to cultivate thoughts of ill-will, and his mind inclines to thoughts of ill-will accordingly. If, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu thinks and ponders a lot about thoughts of harming, then he has abandoned thoughts of non-harming to cultivate thoughts of harming, and his mind inclines to thoughts of harming accordingly.

7. Just as, O bhikkhus, after the rainy season, during the occasion of harvesting in the autumn, a cowherd would guard the cows by tapping and poking them here

and there with a stick to keep them away and ward them off [from the crops]. What is the reason for that? Because the cowherd sees, O bhikkhus, from that as the source, a punishment, imprisonment, a fine or reproach. So too, O bhikkhus, I saw of unwholesome dhammas the danger, degradation and defilement, and of wholesome dhammas the advantages of renunciation, the position of purity.

8. Of me, O bhikkhus, dwelling thus ever vigilant, ardent and resolute, thoughts of renunciation arose. I wisely understood: This thought of renunciation has arisen in me. It neither leads to my own affliction, nor to the affliction of others nor to the affliction of both. It increases wisdom, is on the side of non-vexation and leads to nibbana. Even if I were to think and ponder about it all night, I do not see any fear from it as source. Even if I were to think and ponder about it all day, I do not see any fear from it as source. Even if I were to think and ponder about it all night and day, I do not see any fear from it as source. But thinking and pondering for too long would tire my body. When the body is tired, the mind would be disturbed. A disturbed mind is far from samadhi. So, O bhikkhus, I steadied my mind internally, quietened it, unified it and stilled it. What is the reason for that? “Let my mind not be disturbed.”

9. Of me, O bhikkhus, dwelling thus ever vigilant, ardent and resolute, thoughts of non-ill-will arose. I wisely understood: This thought of non-ill-will has arisen in me.

It neither leads to my own affliction, nor to the affliction of others nor to the affliction of both. It increases wisdom, is on the side of non-vexation and leads to nibbana. Even if I were to think and ponder about it all night, I do not see any fear from it as source. Even if I were to think and ponder about it all day, I do not see any fear from it as source. Even if I were to think and ponder about it all night and day, I do not see any fear from it as source. But thinking and pondering for too long would tire my body. When the body is tired, the mind would be disturbed. A disturbed mind is far from samadhi. So, O bhikkhus, I steadied my mind internally, quietened it, unified it and stilled it. What is the reason for that? “Let my mind not be disturbed.”

10. Of me, O bhikkhus, dwelling thus ever vigilant, ardent and resolute, thoughts of non-harming arose. I wisely understood: This thought of non-harming has arisen in me. It neither leads to my own affliction, nor to the affliction of others nor to the affliction of both. It increases wisdom, is on the side of non-vexation and leads to nibbana. Even if I were to think and ponder about it all night, I do not see any fear from it as source. Even if I were to think and ponder about it all day, I do not see any fear from it as source. Even if I were to think and ponder about it all night and day, I do not see any fear from it as source. But thinking and pondering for too long would tire my body. When the body is tired, the mind would be disturbed. A disturbed mind is far from

samadhi. So, O bhikkhus, I steadied my mind internally, quietened it, unified it and stilled it. What is the reason for that? “Let my mind not be disturbed.”

11. Whatever, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu thinks and ponders a lot about, just that becomes the inclination of the mind. If, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu thinks and ponders a lot about thoughts of renunciation, then he has abandoned thoughts of sensual desire to cultivate thoughts of renunciation, and his mind inclines to thoughts of renunciation accordingly. If, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu thinks and ponders a lot about thoughts of non-ill-will, then he has abandoned thoughts of ill-will to cultivate thoughts of non-ill-will, and his mind inclines to thoughts of non-ill-will accordingly. If, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu thinks and ponders a lot about thoughts of non-harming, then he has abandoned thoughts of harming to cultivate thoughts of non-harming, and his mind inclines to thoughts of non-harming accordingly.

12. Just as, O bhikkhus, after the cold season, when all the crops have been collected in the village, a cowherd having gone to the root of a tree or in the open air, would guard the cows simply by keeping in mind: “Here are the cows.” So too, O bhikkhus, there was simply mindfulness: “There are these dhammas.”

13. For me, O bhikkhus, unsluggish energy was aroused. Unmuddled mindfulness was established. My body was

tranquil and at ease, my mind was unified and attained to samadhi. Quite secluded from sense-desires, O bhikkhus, secluded from unwholesome dhammas, I entered upon and abided in the happiness and pleasure born of seclusion, connected with thinking and pondering, the first jhana.

14. From the subsiding of thinking and pondering, with the internal tranquilization and unification of mind, without thinking and pondering, I entered upon and abided in the happiness and pleasure born of samadhi, the second jhana. With the fading away of happiness, I, dwelling mindful and contemplative, looked on with equanimity as I experienced pleasure in the body, of which the Noble Ones say: “The equanimous dweller in pleasure is the mindful one,” I entered upon and abided in the third jhana. From the abandoning of [physical] pleasure and pain, from the extinction of former mental pleasure and mental pain, I entered upon and abided in the utter purity of mindfulness and equanimity without pain, without pleasure, the fourth jhana.

15. When my samadhi was thus purified, cleansed, unblemished, devoid of defilements, malleable, workable, steady, and attained to imperturbability, I directed it to knowledge of the recollection of past abodes. I recollected my manifold past abodes, that is, one birth, two births, three births, four births, five births, ten births, twenty births, thirty births, forty births, fifty births, a

hundred births, a thousand births, a hundred thousand births, many aeons of world-contraction, many aeons of world expansion, many aeons of world-contraction and expansion thus: “There I was so named, of such a clan, with such an appearance, such was my nutriment, such my experience of pleasure and pain, such my life span; and passing away from there, I appeared elsewhere; and there too I was so named, of such a clan, with such an appearance, such was my nutriment, such my experience of pleasure and pain, such my life span; and passing away from there, I appeared here.” Thus with their aspects and particulars, I recollected my manifold past abodes. This, O bhikkhus, was the first noble knowledge attained by me in the first watch of the night. Ignorance was abandoned, noble knowledge arose. Darkness was abandoned, light arose, as happens for one dwelling vigilant, ardent and resolute.

16. When my samadhi was thus purified, cleansed, unblemished, devoid of defilements, malleable, workable, steady, and attained to imperturbability, I directed it to knowledge of the passing away and reappearance of beings. With the divine eye, which is purified and surpasses the human, I saw beings passing away and appearing, inferior and superior, beautiful and ugly, fortunate and unfortunate. I understood how beings pass on according to their kamma thus: “These worthy beings who were ill-conducted in body, speech, and mind, revilers of Noble Ones, wrong in their views, giving effect to wrong

view in their actions, on the dissolution of the body, after death, have reappeared in a state of deprivation, in a bad destination, in perdition, even in hell; but these worthy beings who were well-conducted in body, speech, and mind, not revilers of Noble Ones, right in their views, giving effect to right view in their actions, on the dissolution of the body, after death, have reappeared in a good destination, even in the heavenly world.” Thus with the divine eye, which is purified and surpasses the human, I saw beings passing away and appearing, inferior and superior, beautiful and ugly, fortunate and unfortunate, and I understood how beings pass on according to their kamma. This, O bhikkhus, was the second noble knowledge attained by me in the second watch of the night. Ignorance was abandoned, noble knowledge arose. Darkness was abandoned, light arose, as happens for one dwelling vigilant, ardent and resolute.

17. When my samadhi was thus purified, cleansed, unblemished, devoid of defilements, malleable, workable, steady, and attained to imperturbability, I directed it to knowledge of the extinction of the asavas. I understood as it has come to be: “This is suffering”; I understood as it has come to be: “This is the origination of suffering”; I understood as it has come to be: “This is the cessation of suffering”; I understood as it has come to be: “This is the path leading to the cessation of suffering.” I understood as it has come to be: “These are the asavas”; I understood as it has come to be: “This is the origination

of the asavas”; I understood as it has come to be: “This is the cessation of the asavas”; I understood as it has come to be: “This is the path leading to the cessation of the asavas.” When I knew and saw thus, my mind was liberated from the asava of sensual desire, from the asava of being, and from the asava of ignorance. When it was liberated there came the knowledge: “It is liberated.” I understood “Birth is extincted, the life of purity has been lived, what had to be done has been done, there is nothing else for thusness.” This, O bhikkhus, was the third noble knowledge attained by me in the third watch of the night. Ignorance was abandoned, noble knowledge arose. Darkness was abandoned, light arose, as happens for one dwelling vigilant, ardent and resolute.

18. Suppose, O bhikkhus, that a great community of deer were to live in dependence on a small lake in an extensive valley of a woodland forest. For them some man might arise, one who wishes their harm, one who wishes their ruin, one who wishes for their danger. He would close the path which would be safe, auspicious, leading to happiness. He would open a wrong path, would set up a decoy, and put a tamed and trained female deer on one side. Thus indeed, O bhikkhus, the great community of deer on a later occasion would undergo decimation, ruin and misfortune.

19. However, O bhikkhus, for just that great community of deer, another man might arise, one who wishes their

benefit, one who wishes their welfare, one who wishes for their release from bondage. He would open the path which would be safe, auspicious, leading to happiness. He would close the wrong path, destroy the decoy, drive away the tamed and trained female deer. Thus that great community of deer on a later occasion, would undergo increase, growth and abundance.

20. This simile, O bhikkhus, is made by me for conveying a meaning. Just this is the meaning: "Small lake in an extensive valley," O bhikkhus, this is a designation for sensual pleasures. "The great community of deer," O bhikkhus, this is a designation for beings. "Man who wishes their harm, ruin and danger," O bhikkhus, this is a designation for Mara, the Evil One. "Wrong path," O bhikkhus, this is a designation for the wrong eight-fold path. That is wrong view, wrong thought, wrong speech, wrong action, wrong livelihood, wrong effort, wrong mindfulness, wrong samadhi. "The decoy," O bhikkhus, this is a designation for lusting after delight. "The tamed and trained female deer," O bhikkhus, this is a designation for ignorance. "Man who wishes their benefit, welfare and release from bondage," O bhikkhus, this is a designation for the Tathagata, the arahant, the rightly self-awakened One. "The path which would be safe, auspicious, leading to happiness," O bhikkhus, this is a designation for the noble eight fold path. That is right view, right thought, right speech, right action, right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness, right samadhi.

21. Thus, O bhikkhus, opened by me is the path which is safe, auspicious, leading to happiness. The wrong path is closed, the decoy destroyed, the tamed and trained female deer removed. Whatever should be done, O bhikkhus, by a teacher for his disciples, desiring their welfare, having pity for them, that has been done for you by me, out of compassion. These are the feet of trees, O bhikkhus, these are empty huts. Meditate, O bhikkhus, do not be negligent, lest you regret it later. This is our instructions to you.”

22. This is what the Auspicious One said. Delighted, those bhikkhus rejoiced in the Auspicious One’s words.